

Revive the Multimedia XPerience with

The XBMC logo is displayed on a dark blue, rounded rectangular background. The letters 'xb' are in a bright green color, while 'mc' is in white. The background of the entire page features a stylized sunburst pattern in red and orange, with a yellow film strip winding across it.

Let's take XBMC for a test drive to discover its media-playing as well as media centre capabilities.

The dropping prices of computer hardware are a definite help in building decent home-theatre systems with ease. Media centre computer software helps to enhance the viewing experience, as they employ features with great eye candy. Also, there is a range of media centre solutions and software that we can choose from today.

Here, we'll take a look at one of the most prominent open source media centre applications—XBMC.

I tested XBMC on the following set-up:

- Processor: AMD Phenom X4 9950 BE @ 3.1GHz | AMD Phenom II X2 550 BE

@ 4GHz

- Motherboard: AMD 790GX with ATI HD 3300 IGP | ATI Radeon HD4770 dedicated
- RAM: 4GB DDR2 800 MHz RAM running @ 1090MHz
- Monitor: Samsung S2233SW with 1920x1080, 16:9 (full high definition) resolution
- Sound card: Realtek ALC888 8 channel audio
- Speakers: Klipsch Promedia GMX 2.1 | Altec Lansing MX5021
- Operating systems: Ubuntu 9.04 64 bit, Mandriva 2009.1 KDE 32 bit, Sabayon 4.2 KDE 64 bit and Dreamlinux 3.5